

Burj Khalifa

Serving as offices, residential apartments and a hotel, the Burj Khalifa, named after the ruler of Abu Dhabi and president of the UAE, is the tallest building in the world at 829.8 metres (2,722 ft) high. Despite its unique appearance, designed to attract international notice, the structure is built on conventional construction methods, albeit modified to cope with the building's unique demands.

The Y-shaped plan is formed by three wings connected to a central core, which makes it ultra-stable. The wings contain the residential units and hotel guest rooms, and the central core supports the colossal height of the building as well as housing all the elevators and mechanical systems. Rising above this reinforced concrete section of the building is the structural steel spire, which is decorated with traditional Islamic forms. The spire also highlights the tower's resemblance to a spiral minaret, helping to put an otherwise universal, international building in its local historical and cultural context.

